Effective Date:
01/01/2026

Background:
The MNB program is a state-funded supplemental food benefit program for eligible households (HHs) that will operate from December 1, 2025, through November 30, 2026, pending availability of state funding.

Purpose:
This section introduces MNB policy information and Electronic Benefits Transfer (EBT) benefit issuance type code "MNB."

Policy:
The MNB program provides up to 12 months of additional food benefits to certain HHs receiving less than $60 monthly in CalFresh or California Food Assistance Program (CFAP) benefits. Eligible HHs will receive a monthly supplement that will bring the total amount of CalFresh benefits up to $60 during the pilot period.

1. Eligibility Criteria and Benefit Determination

Eligible HHs must meet all the following requirements:

- Be eligible for a monthly CalFresh benefit of less than $60 with a beginning date of aid on or before December 1, 2025.
- Have conferred Elderly Simplified Application Project (ESAP) status on or before December 1, 2025.
- Have at least two CalFresh-eligible HH members.

HHs that apply for CalFresh or are conferred ESAP status after December 1, 2025, are not eligible to participate in the MNB program.

For approved MNB HHs whose monthly CalFresh benefits are reduced due to recoupment of an overissuance, the MNB benefits will be calculated based on the full CalFresh eligibility amount before the benefit reduction.

Example:

If…	then…
the HH is eligible for $46 in CalFresh, but receives only $36 due to benefit recoupment,	the HH will receive $14 in MNB benefits. $60 Total food benefit - $46 CalFresh amount prior to recoupment = $14 MNB benefits

Notes: HHs receiving Supplemental Nutrition Benefit (SNB) are ineligible to the MNB program. Additionally, HHs that receive a prorated CalFresh benefit for any reason are not eligible to MNB benefits for that month.

2. Discontinuance and Reinstatement

HHs that no longer meet MNB eligibility requirements will be discontinued from the program effective the first of the month following timely notice.

HHs that regain MNB eligibility through a rescind, restoration, or reapplication, without a break in aid of more than 30 calendar days, will resume receiving MNB program benefits for the remainder of the pilot period. HHs with a break in aid exceeding 30 calendar days will not be eligible for any remaining months of the MNB program.

3. Overissuances and Underissuances

Process all corrections to MNB program benefits separately from CalFresh error corrections.

If a HH's CalFresh benefit increases to $60 or more, discontinue the MNB program with timely notice. Do not establish overissuances for any MNB benefits issued in error. MNB benefits cannot be used to repay any CalFresh overissuances.

If a HH received more CalFresh benefits than they were eligible for, the correct CalFresh benefit amount must first be determined, and any necessary CalFresh overissuance established. The MNB benefits must then be recalculated based on the corrected CalFresh benefit amount. The HH must be issued the difference between the MNB benefits previously received and the amount for which they are now eligible.

Example:
A HH of two with conferred ESAP status is determined eligible for $40 in CalFresh and $20 in MNB program benefits for December 2025. CalFresh eligibility is later corrected to $65 for December 2025, and the HH is therefore eligible for a $25 CalFresh supplement. MNB benefits are discontinued with timely notice, and no overissuance is established for the MNB benefits received in error.

December 2025	Original Benefit	Recalculated Benefit	Overissuance	Supplement
CalFresh	$40	$65	--	$25
MNB	$20	$0	N/A	--
Total Monthly Food Benefit	$60	$65		

Example:
A HH of two with conferred ESAP status is determined eligible for $70 in CalFresh for December 2025. The CalFresh benefit amount exceeds $60 and is therefore ineligible for the MNB program. CalFresh eligibility is later corrected to $24 for December 2025, and a CalFresh overissuance of $46 is established. Since all MNB program eligibility factors are now met, issue a $36 MNB supplement.

December 2025	Original Benefit	Recalculated Benefit	Overissuance	Supplement
CalFresh	$70	$24	$46	--
MNB	$0	$36	--	$36
Total Monthly Food Benefit	$70	$60		

Note: No MNB benefits may be issued after June 30, 2027, under any circumstances.

4. Additional Considerations

- MNB program benefits will not be replaced due to disaster, HH misfortune, or electronic theft.
- HHs requesting a state hearing may still be eligible for Aid Paid Pending (APP) for regular CalFresh benefits, however there is no eligibility for APP relating to MNB benefits.
- Errors specific to MNB will not count toward Quality Control (QC) error rates.

5. MNB Benefit Issuance Type Code and Use of Benefits

MNB program benefits are issued onto the HHs existing EBT card under the MNB benefit issuance type code. Once issued, MNB program benefits are used in the same manner as regular CalFresh benefits, including at Restaurant Meals Program (RMP) providers, if the HH is otherwise eligible.

MNB program benefits are subject to the same EBT expungement rules as regular CalFresh benefits.

6. Forms and Notices

The following NOAs were developed for the MNB program and must be used:

Form	Definition
CF 378A	Notice of Approval for the CalFresh Minimum Nutrition Benefit Pilot Program
CF 378B	Notice of Discontinuance for the CalFresh Minimum Nutrition Benefit Pilot Program

The CF 378A must be issued when a HH is approved for the MNB program. A new CF 378A is not required if the MNB program benefits increase or decrease during the pilot period due to changes in the CalFresh benefit amount.

The CF 378B must be issued when a HH is discontinued from the MNB program, either due to ineligibility or at the end of the pilot period. Timely and adequate notice requirements apply.

If…	then…
CalFresh benefits are discontinued, or increase to $60, or more,	issue the 378B informing of the MNB program discontinuance along with a CalFresh benefit change notice.

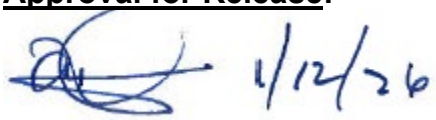
The CF 378A and 378B are available in English and Spanish only. For HHs that require translation services in other languages, issue notices with a Notice of Language Services (GEN 1365).

Note: The EBT Replacement Denial (M44-350K) Notice of Action (NOA) has been updated to include a denial reason specific to the MNB program.

References:
All County Letter (ACL) 20-145, 17-34, 22-15, 22-62, 23-92, 24-62, 25-01, and 25-59.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by 11/30/2026.

Approval for Release:



Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services